

Abubakar Khawaja

Senior Full-Stack Engineer | React | Next.js | Django | PostgreSQL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-Stack Engineer with 5+ years of experience architecting and shipping production software across React, Next.js, Django, and PostgreSQL. I take features from first idea to live deployment, prioritizing clean UI architecture, highly concurrent APIs, and robust asynchronous pipelines that hold up under real-world load. I am comfortable owning system design, database performance, and critical third-party integrations, and I thrive on solving complex, end-to-end engineering problems.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Full-Stack Engineer | Arbisoft

2021 – 2026

- Cut API response times by 30-70% across core endpoints by resolving N+1 queries, optimizing ORM access patterns, and implementing strategic PostgreSQL indexing.
- Architected asynchronous processing pipelines using Celery to handle heavy background workloads, including bulk PDF generation and scalable reporting systems managing 1,000+ assets.
- Reworked GitLab CI/CD pipelines with parallel jobs and layer caching, reducing deployment times by 40%.
- Elevated automated test coverage from 10% to over 60% (Jest, Cypress, Vitest) and integrated quality gates (ESLint, Husky), reducing production bugs by 25%.
- Redesigned React frontend architecture, reducing unnecessary re-renders by 30% and improving page load times by 20-30% via memoization, code-splitting, and optimized state management.
- Owned end-to-end third-party integrations across multiple production platforms, including Stripe for payments, SendGrid for transactional emails, and Looker for BI analytics.
- Implemented SSR, Static Site Generation, and modern frontend optimization techniques using Next.js to improve SEO and Core Web Vitals.
- Developed interactive analytics dashboards using Chart.js and Google Looker to visualize business KPIs and operational insights.
- Leveraged AI development tools including ChatGPT and GitHub Copilot to accelerate development, improve code quality, and streamline debugging and implementation workflows.
- Volunteered in Arbisoft's graduate hiring process by designing and reviewing technical assessments used to evaluate entry-level software engineering candidates.
- Built GitHub Actions automation to validate documentation integrity and prevent inconsistent generated documentation from reaching production.

SELECTED PROJECTS

FixAlert, Maintenance Platform · [React + Django](#)

- Resolved redundant database lookups to maintain API responsiveness under heavy load.
- Smoothed asynchronous workflows with Celery for bulk PDF generation and wired up Stripe payments.
- Designed asynchronous Celery workflows for QR generation, bulk PDF exports, and automated report generation.

Landit, Career Platform · [React + Next.js](#)

- Executed zero-downtime frontend framework migrations (Material UI v4 to v5, React Router v4 to v5).
- Developed custom Looker BI visualizations and scalable SendGrid email templates.

AskImam, Q&A Platform · [React + Django](#)

- Led backend migration from Django 2.x to 5.1, significantly improving runtime stability.
- Hardened authentication security and built full-stack features including an enhanced admin dashboard.

Convo, Real-Time Chat Platform · [React + Django](#) · [Personal Project](#)

- Implemented live messaging over WebSockets using Django Channels and Redis.
- Configured JWT authentication, user profiles, and a complete CI/CD pipeline.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Python, SQL, HTML5, CSS3/SCSS

Frontend: React.js, Next.js, Redux Toolkit, TanStack Query, React Hook Form, Tailwind CSS, Material UI, SCSS

Backend: Django, Django REST Framework, REST API design, Celery (async/task queues), Django Channels

Backend Integration: REST APIs, GraphQL, API Design Collaboration

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, Query Optimization, Database Indexing, Caching Strategies

Integrations: Stripe (payments), SendGrid (email), WebSockets, JWT auth, Google Looker (BI), Google Analytics

Testing: Jest, Cypress, Vitest, React Testing Library, Django Test Framework

DevOps: GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Docker, Nginx, Git, ESLint, Prettier, Husky, AWS, Vercel

Foundations: Data Structures & Algorithms, System Design, Performance Optimization, Agile/Scrum, Code Review, Mentoring

Frontend Engineering: Performance Profiling, Code Splitting, Lazy Loading, Accessibility (WCAG), Responsive Design, Component Architecture

Data Visualization: Chart.js, Google Looker, Analytics Dashboards, Interactive Charts

AI Development: ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Prompt Engineering, AI-Assisted Development

AI/ML: Prompt Engineering, Context Engineering, Embeddings, Vector Databases, RAG, Vercel AI SDK

EDUCATION

B.S. Software Engineering Punjab University College of Information & Technology (PUCIT) · GPA: 3.08

CERTIFICATIONS

- The AI Engineer Path & Prompt Engineering for Web Developers — Scrimba (July 2026)